model', corporates can be allowed to outsource theoretical training, and educational institutions can be allowed to outsource practical training.

v. *Active Exchanges:* There should be active exchanges and portals, matching prospective apprentices to employers.

WAY TO EVIDENCE-BASED BETTER POLICY

Educational investments contribute to aggregate economic growth. More than this, they enable citizens to broadly participate in the growth process through improved productivity, employment, and wages, and are therefore a critical component of the 'inclusive growth' agenda of the Government of India. The past decade has seen substantial increases in education investments under the Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA), and this additional spending has led to considerable progress in improving primary school access, infrastructure, pupil-teacher ratios, teacher salaries, and student enrollment. Nevertheless, student learning levels and trajectories are disturbingly low, with nationally representative studies showing that over 60 per cent of children aged 6-14 are unable to read at second-grade level. Further, these figures have shown no sign of improving over time (and may even be deteriorating).[45]

The decade also saw a number of high-quality empirical studies on the causes and correlates of better learning outcomes based on large samples of data and careful attention paid to identification of causal relationships. This research has identified interventions/inputs that do not appear to contribute meaningfully to improved education outcomes, as well as interventions that are highly effective. In particular, the research over the past decade suggests that increasing inputs to primary education in a 'business-as-usual' way is unlikely to improve student learning meaningfully unless accompanied by significant changes in pedagogy and/or improvements in school governance. It is, therefore, imperative that *education policy shifts* its emphasis from simply providing more school inputs in a 'business-as-usual' way and focuses on improving 'education outcomes'.